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SPECIFICATION FOR AN ARCHAEOLOGICAL EVALUATION

Eastern Villages
Land North Of A420
South Marston and Rowborough
Swindon

April 2014

Planning • Heritage

Specialist & Independent Advisors to the Property Industry

Local Planning Authority:
Swindon Borough Council Council

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CONTENTS

1.0 Introduction and Scope of Document

2.0 Aims and Objectives

3.0 Method Statement

4.0 Monitoring

5.0 Health and Safety

Sources Consulted

LIST OF FIGURES

Fig. 1 Geophysical survey results

Fig. 2 Trench Plan Plotted against geophysical survey results

Fig. 3 Trench Plan Plotted against development layout

1.0 INTRODUCTION

1.1 This Archaeological Written Scheme of Investigation (WSI) has been prepared by Rob Bourn of CgMs Consulting on behalf of Hallam Land Management, Taylor Wimpey and Hennick Homes.

1.2 Outline planning permission has been applied for a sustainable urban extension for up to 2,380 dwellings, a mixed use local centre and mixed use areas, community uses, sheltered accommodation, a primary school, green infrastructure including formal and informal open space, sports facilities, sustainable drainage, engineering works including ground re-modelling, other infrastructure, demolition and the formation of new accesses from the A420, Old Vicarage Lane, Thornhill Road. Subsequent to the submission of the planning application, discussions have been held with Swindon Borough Council and Wiltshire Council regarding the provision of additional information regarding the archaeological potential of the proposed development site.

1.3 This WSI details a programme of archaeological investigation to evaluate the development site's archaeological potential and enable the impact of the new development to be fully assessed.

1.4 This WSI conforms to the requirements of the National Planning Policy Framework (DCLG 2012) (NPPF). It has been designed in accordance with current best archaeological practice and the appropriate national standards and guidelines including:

- *Management of Archaeological Projects* (English Heritage, 1991);
- *Model Briefs and Specifications for Archaeological Assessments and Field Evaluations* (Association of County Archaeological Officers, 1994);
- *Code of Conduct* (Institute of Field Archaeologists, 2000);
- *Standard and Guidance for Archaeological Field Evaluations* (Institute for Archaeologists, 2013).

1.5 The archaeological background (i.e. a discussion about the wider archaeological context in which the application site is located) is outlined in Chapter 10 of the ES supporting the planning application and will not be repeated here.

1.6 The areas of the site that are proposed for development have been subject to a geophysical magnetometer survey (Appendix 1 & 2). This has revealed a large

number of anomalies of probable and possible archaeological origin that are likely to at least one, if not two or three settlements, trackways and field systems throughout a large area of the site that are likely to be late prehistoric and/or Roman in date (Fig. 1).

1.7 The survey recorded a complex set of anomalies of archaeological origin to the south, east and south east of Manor Farm and west of South Marston Farm. This complex of anomalies is interpreted as a late prehistoric/Romano-British settlement and associated field system of more than one phase of occupation. The complex appears to have a coherent structure enabling the identification of the core of the settlement toward South Marston Farm, with paddocks/animal pens and fields extending out to the west, north and north east of the core. The edges of the settlement complex have been established as lying just to the south of Manor Farm, the west of South Marston Farm and to the east of both Manor and South Marston Farms. The settlement and field system complex extends beyond the application boundary to the north west of South Marston Farm and beyond the survey area to the east of South Marston Farm. Trackways leading out of the settlement have been identified to the west and north west of South Marston Farm and to the south east of Manor Farm.

1.8 An apparently separate set of anomalies of archaeological origin have been recorded immediately to the west of Manor Farm. These appear to form part of a 'ladder' settlement of probable Iron Age date. The settlement extends beyond the western boundary of the Application Site.

1.9 Three large circular features and a much smaller fourth circular anomaly, along with a number of rectangular enclosures and linear features, have been recorded toward the north eastern corner of the Application Site. The function and date of the large circular anomalies are unclear. They are too big to be hut circles or ring ditches. It is possible that they are a type of monument known as 'Highworth Circles', which have been postulated as being medieval cattle pens or industrial areas. It is also possible that the anomalies could be prehistoric. The circles do not appear to be contemporary with the enclosures, as one of the linear anomalies appears to cut across the smallest circle.

1.10 A series of linear anomalies have been recorded to the south of these features which have been interpreted as being the remains of a trackway, fieldsystem and three enclosures that could be small farmsteads or non-domestic enclosures.

1.11 The evaluation will be undertaken by Foundations Archaeology according to this WSI and under the supervision of CgMs.

2.0 AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

2.1 The aims of the archaeological evaluation are:

- To determine, as far as reasonably practicable, the location, extent, date, character, condition, significance and quality of any surviving archaeological remains.
- To assess vulnerability/sensitivity of any exposed remains
- To establish the ecofactual and environmental potential of archaeological deposits and features encountered.
- To assess the impact of previous land use on the site.
- To establish the potential for significant environmental deposits.
- To provide sufficient information on the archaeological potential of the site to enable that archaeological implications of the proposed development to be assessed
- To inform formulation of a strategy to avoid or mitigate impacts of the proposed development on surviving archaeological remains
- To produce a site archive for deposition with an appropriate museum and to provide information for accession to the Wiltshire HER.

2.2 The results of the evaluation will enable reasoned and informed recommendations to be made to the local planning authority and, if appropriate, a suitable mitigation strategy for the proposed development to be formulated. Further archaeological work will require subsequent WSI documentation.

2.3 The field evaluation will be conducted within the general parameters defined by the IfA's Standard and Guidance for Archaeological Evaluation (as revised).

3.0 METHOD STATEMENT

3.1 In order that the investigation supplies information of the required quality, the Codes, Standards and Guidance issued by the Institute of Field Archaeologists (IfA) form a requirement of this specification.

3.2 Seventy six 50m x 2m trenches and two 30m x 2m trenches will be excavated as per the layout shown on Fig. 2 & 3.

3.3 Trench locations will be scanned with a Cable Avoidance Tool (CAT) prior to excavation.

3.4 Topsoil and overburden will be removed by mechanical excavator using a toothless ditching bucket (c.1.8m wide), under archaeological supervision. The spoil generated during the evaluation will be mounded away from the edges of each trench. Topsoil and subsoil will be stored separately. Mechanical excavation will cease at either undisturbed natural deposits or the top of archaeological deposits. Upcast & spoil from mechanical excavation will be scanned by eye and by metal detector to aid the recovery of topsoil artefacts.

3.5 Each trench will be cleaned by hand as necessary to assist the identification and interpretation of exposed archaeological features and the nature of identified features assessed by limited sample excavation. All exposed features will be investigated (unless otherwise agreed with the County Archaeological Officer). Discrete features (e.g. infilled pits) will be half- or quarter-sectioned; as a minimum (where possible) a 1m wide section of each linear feature will be excavated by hand.

3.6 Particular care should be taken not to damage any areas containing significant remains which might merit preservation in-situ. Such evidence would normally include deep or complex stratification, settlement evidence and structures. Such areas should be protected and not left open to the weather, or other forms of deterioration. Whilst investigation will not be at the expense of any structures, features or finds which might reasonably be considered to merit preservation, it is important that a sufficient sample is studied.

3.7 Should the excavation of the trenches reach 1.2m in depth (or limit of safe working depth) without natural geology being encountered, a machine dug sondage will be excavated in order to establish the depth of natural geology.

3.8 The trenches will be recorded at an appropriate scale (1:20 where features are found to be present) by measured drawing and photography and will be located to Ordnance Survey National Grid. The deposits encountered described fully on individual context recording sheets. The sections of excavated archaeological features will also be recorded by measured drawing at an appropriate scale (normally 1:10). Spot heights and those of individual features will be recorded relative to Ordnance Datum.

3.9 A photographic record, utilising black and white negative film, supplemented by high resolution digital data capture, will be maintained during the course of the fieldwork and will include:

- the site prior to commencement of fieldwork;
- the site during work, showing specific stages of fieldwork;
- the layout of archaeological features within each trench;
- individual features and, where appropriate, their sections;
- groups of features where their relationship is important.

3.10 All artefacts will be treated in accordance with UKIC guidelines, *First Aid for Finds* (1998). All finds will be bagged and labelled according to the individual deposit from which they were recovered, ready for later cleaning and analysis.

3.11 If finds are made that might constitute 'Treasure' under the definition of the Treasure Act (1996), these will if possible be archaeologically excavated and removed to a safe place. Such finds will also be reported immediately to the local Coroner (within 14 days, in accordance with the Act). Should it not be possible to remove the finds that day suitable security will be arranged.

3.12 The environmental sampling strategy will include the routine sampling of deposits for the retrieval and assessment of the preservation conditions and potential for analysis of all biological or industrial remains. All environmental work will be undertaken in accordance with English Heritage guidelines (see *Environmental Archaeology: A guide to the theory and practice of methods, from sampling and recovery to post-excavation (second edition)*, Centre for Archaeology Guidelines 20011). Sample sizes will normally be 40-60 litres unless the deposit is smaller in volume. Samples will be directed to a representative range of context type from each phase, and examine:

- Survival of material
- Key archaeological contexts

- Potential

3.13 Should waterlogged deposits be encountered they will be left *in situ* until such time as further mitigation works are required. If this is not possible then further consultation with a suitable specialist will determine methods for recovery.

3.14 Any human remains encountered will be cleaned with minimal disturbance, recorded and left *in situ* and only removed if necessary. The contractor will comply with all statutory consents and licences under the Disused Burial Grounds (Amendment) Act, 1981 or other Burial Acts regarding the exhumation and interment of human remains. The archaeological contractor will comply with all reasonable requests of interested parties as to the method of removal, re-interment or disposal of the remains or associated items. Every effort will be made, at all times, not to cause offence to any interested parties. The Historic Environment Planning Officer and the local coroner will be informed immediately if human remains are discovered.

3.15 Upon completion of the evaluation trenching, excavated trenches will be backfilled with arisings and loosely compacted. Trenches will not be backfilled without prior agreement with the County Archaeological Officer.

3.16 Post-excavation work will comprise the following:

- checking of drawn and written records during and on completion of fieldwork;
- production of a stratigraphic matrix of the archaeological deposits and features present on the site, if appropriate;
- cataloguing of photographic material and labeling of slides that will be mounted on appropriate hangers;
- cleaning, marking, bagging and labelling of finds according to the individual deposits from which they were recovered. Any finds requiring specialist treatment and conservation will be sent for appropriate treatment. Finds will be identified and dated by appropriate specialists.

3.17 Unless otherwise agreed with the County Archaeological Officer, a report detailing the findings of the archaeological trial works will be prepared within three weeks of the completion of site works and will consist of:

- a title page detailing site address, site code and accession number, NGR, author/originating body, client's name and address;
- HER summary sheet;
- full contents listing;
- a non-technical summary of the findings of the evaluation;

- a description of the topography and geology of the evaluation area;
- a description of the methodologies used during the evaluation;
- a description of the findings of the evaluation;
- site and trench location plans and plans of each of the trenches/areas showing the archaeological features exposed;
- sections of the excavated archaeological features;
- interpretation of the archaeological features exposed and their context within the surrounding landscape;
- specialist reports on the artefactual/ecofactual remains from the site;
- appropriate photographs of specific archaeological features;
- a predictive model of surviving archaeological remains, where affected by development proposals and their relative importance
- a full context list
- the OASIS reference and summary form

3.18 The format and contents of the report will conform to Wiltshire County Council requirements and to published regional Standards.

3.19 A draft copy of the report will be supplied to the County Archaeological Officer for comment. Following approval of the draft report, one copy of the approved report will be provided to the LPA; one hard copy and one digital copy will be supplied to Hertfordshire HER.

3.20 A copy of the approved report will be uploaded to the OASIS database.

3.21 The project archive will be prepared according to the recommendations in *Guidelines for the Preparation of Excavation Archives for long-term storage* (UKIC 1990), and *Standards in the Museum Care of Archaeological Collections* (Museums and Galleries Commission 1992).

3.22 The project archive will be deposited with the appropriate repository in accordance with the terms and conditions which will be agreed with the store in advance of deposition.

3.23 Notes or articles describing the results of the archaeological fieldwork will be submitted for publication to an appropriate journal, dependant on the nature of the results.

3.24 OASIS (**O**nline **A**cces**S** to the **I**ndex of archaeological investigation**S**) data capture forms will also be completed and submitted on completion of the project.

4.0 MONITORING

4.1 The aims of monitoring are to ensure that the archaeological works are undertaken within the limits set by this specification, and to the satisfaction of the County Archaeological Officer.

4.2 CgMs will monitor implementation of the programme of works on behalf of the developer, Hallam Land Management, Taylor Wimpey and Hannick Homes.

4.3 The County Archaeological Officer will be given notice of when work is due to commence and will be free to visit the site. The County Archaeological Officer will monitor implementation of the programme of works on behalf of the Local Planning Authority and evaluate the work being undertaken on site against the methodology detailed in this specification. If necessary the LPA and HCC will be free to contact the contractor, Foundations Archaeology directly (01793 525 993).

4.4 The County Archaeological Officer will also be responsible for considering any changes to the specification of works; any such alterations should be agreed in writing with the relevant parties prior to commencement of on site works, or at the earliest available opportunity.

5.0 HEALTH and SAFETY

11.1 All works will be in compliance with the Health and Safety at Work Act (1974) and all applicable regulations and Codes of Practice and the Construction Design Management Regulations 2007.

11.2 All archaeological staff will undertake their operations in accordance with safe working practices.

11.3 A site-specific risk assessment will be undertaken and recorded prior to the commencement of work on site, a copy of which will be sent to the County Archaeological Officer.

11.4 A continuous process of dynamic risk assessment will be undertaken and if significant hazards are identified a specific risk assessment will be undertaken and recorded. Control measures will be implemented as required in response to specific hazards.

11.5 Safe working will take priority over the desire to record archaeological features or remains, and where it is considered that recording is dangerous, any such features or remains will be recorded by photography, at a safe distance.

SOURCES CONSULTED

Carver *Underneath English Towns* 1987

CgMs Consulting *Archaeological Desk Based Assessment Hertford Police Station Ware Road Hertford Hertfordshire* October 2012 unpublished document

National Guidance:

Department of Communities and Local Government *National Planning Policy Framework* 2012

Department of Communities and Local Government/Department of Culture Media and Sport/English Heritage *PPS5 Planning for the Historic Environment: Historic Environment Planning Practice Guide* 2010

English Heritage *Comparison of PPS5 Policies with Historic Environment-Related Policies in the NPPF – Part 1* 5 April 2012 unpublished document

English Heritage *Comparison of PPS5 Policies with Historic Environment-Related Policies in the NPPF – Part 2* 5 April 2012 unpublished document

Institute for Archaeologists Guidelines:

http://www.archaeologists.net/sites/default/files/node-files/code_conduct.pdf
http://www.archaeologists.net/sites/default/files/node-files/ifa_code_practice.pdf

English Heritage Guidelines:

MAP2 Management of Archaeological Projects (Second Edition) 1991

MoRPHE Management of Research Projects in the Historic Environment The MoRPHE Project Managers' Guide 2009

MoRPHE Management of Research Projects in the Historic Environment PPN 3: Archaeological Excavation January 2008

Guidelines for archiving:

Archaeological Archives Forum (Duncan H. Brown), *Archaeological Archives: a guide to best practice in creation, completion, transfer and collection* 2007

London Archaeological Archive Resource Centre (LAARC) *Guidelines for the Preparation of Archaeological Archives*

Museum and Galleries Commission *Standards in the Museum Care of Archaeological Collections* 1992

Museum of London *Standards for the Preparation of Finds to be Permanently Retained by the Museum of London*

Museum of London *A research framework for London archaeology* 2002

Society of Museum Archaeologists *Selection and Retention and Dispersal of Archaeological Collections* draft 1992

Society of Museum Archaeologists *Towards an Accessible Archaeological Archive. The Transfer of Archaeological Archives to Museums: Guidelines for Use in England, Northern Ireland Scotland and Wales* 1995.

Amendments

Issue No.	Date	Description

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Plotting parameters

Maximum +2nT (black)
Minimum -1nT (white)

+2nT
-1nT

Job No.	Survey Date
XXXX	MARCH 13

Client: CgMs

Project Title: GEOPHYSICAL SURVEY - LAND EAST OF SWINDON

Subject: CURRENT AND PREVIOUS SURVEYS - PROCESSED GRADIOMETER DATA

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Scale 1:3000 — 0m 30 60 90 120 150 180m

Plot	Checked by	Issue No.
A1	PPB	01
Date	**Drawn by**	**Figure No.**
APRIL 13	OJP	A

N

Not to Scale:
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Figure 1:
Geophysical Survey Results

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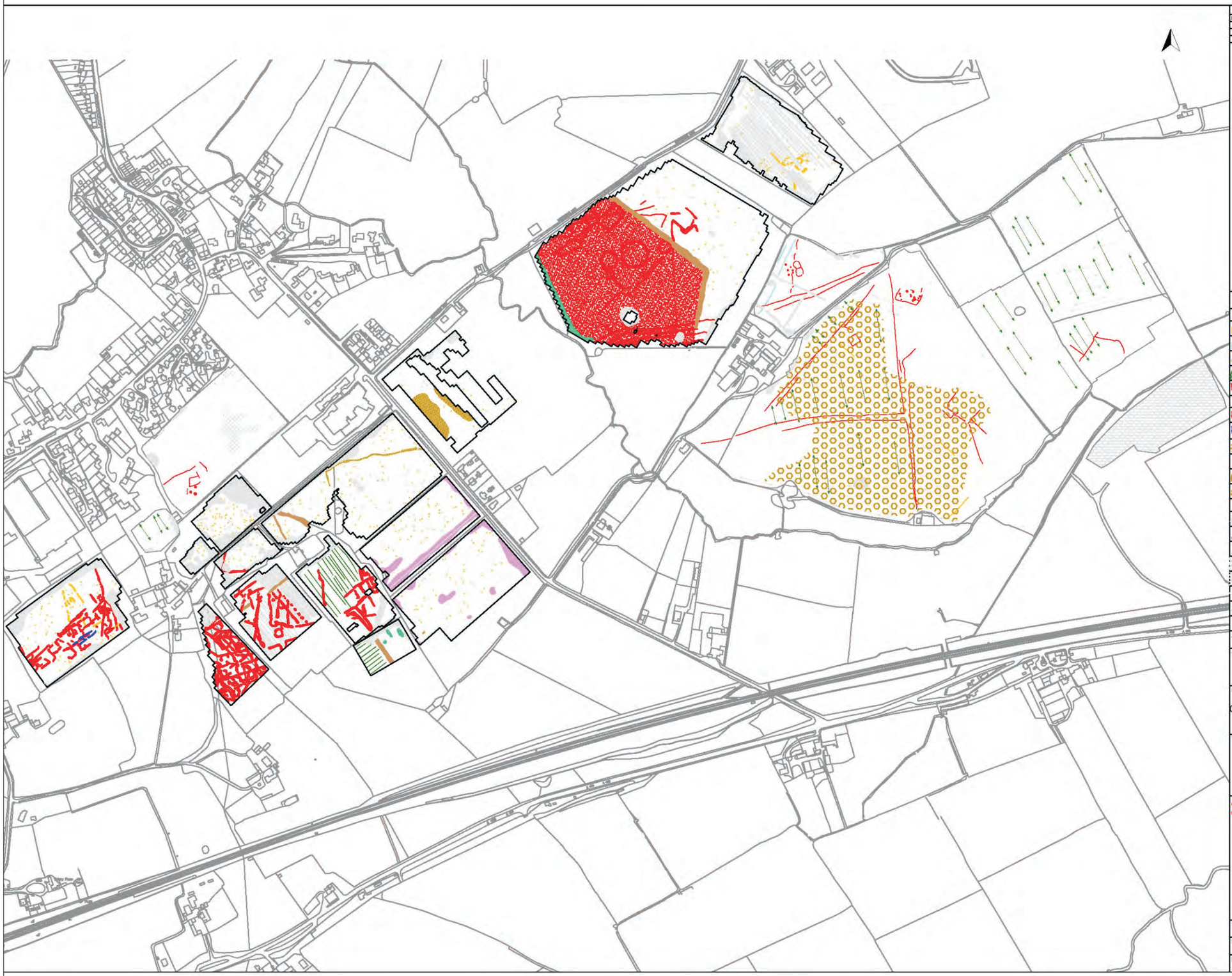

Amendments

Issue No.	Date	Description
-	-	
-	-	

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KEY

PROBABLE ARCHAEOLOGY

- Positive anomaly / weak positive anomaly - probable cut feature of archaeological origin
- Negative anomaly / weak negative anomaly - probable bank or earthwork of archaeological origin
- Moderate strength discrete anomaly - probable thermoremanent feature
- Widely spaced curving parallel linear anomalies - probably related to ridge-and-furrow
- Area of probable pitting of archaeological origin

POSSIBLE ARCHAEOLOGY

- Positive anomaly / weak positive anomaly - possible cut feature of archaeological origin
- Negative anomaly / weak negative anomaly - possible bank or earthwork of archaeological origin
- Area of amorphous magnetic variation - probable natural (e.g. geological or pedological) origin
- Positive anomaly - uncertain origin
- Increased magnetic response - former field boundary
- Area of possible pitting - likely of archaeological origin

OTHER ANOMALIES

- Closely spaced parallel linear anomalies - probably related to agricultural activity such as ploughing
- Linear anomaly - probably related to pipe, cable or other modern service
- Linear anomaly - possibly related to land drain
- Magnetic disturbance associated with nearby metal object such as service or field boundary
- Strong magnetic debris - possible disturbed or made ground
- Scattered magnetic debris
- Area of amorphous magnetic variation - probable natural (e.g. geological or pedological) origin
- Magnetic spike - probable ferrous object

Job No.	Survey Date
XXXX	MARCH 13

Client: CgMs

Project Title: GEOPHYSICAL SURVEY - LAND EAST OF SWINDON

Subject: CURRENT AND PREVIOUS SURVEYS - ABSTRACTION AND INTERPRETATION

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Plot	Checked by	Issue No.
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Figure 1:
Geophysical Survey Results

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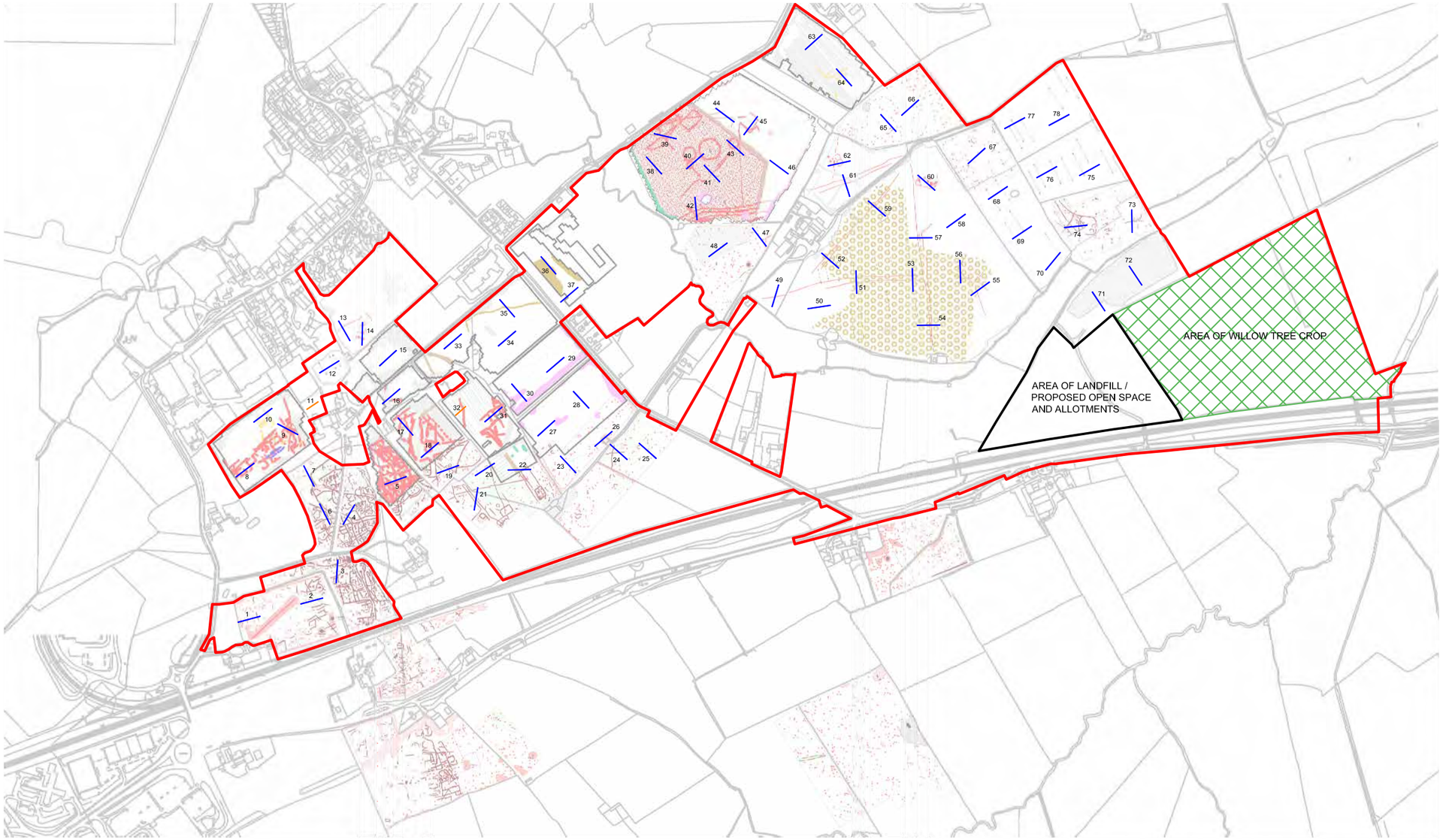

Additional information:

Site Boundary

Proposed Trench Location 50m x 2m (76 total)

Proposed Trench Location 30m x 2m (2 total)

N

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0 250 m

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Figure 2: Trench Plan Plotted against Geophysical Survey Results

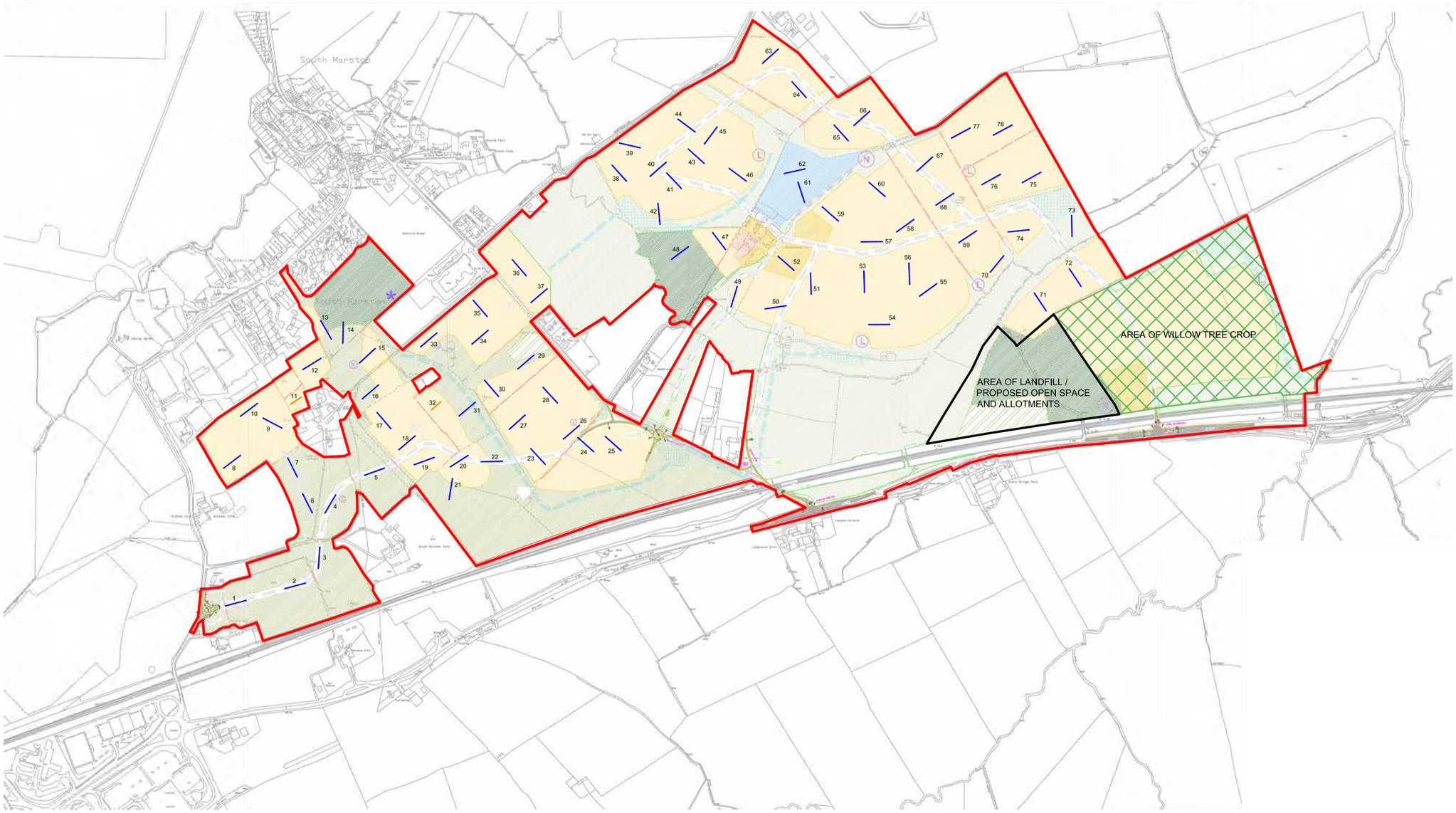

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Figure 3: Trench Plan Plotted against Development Layout